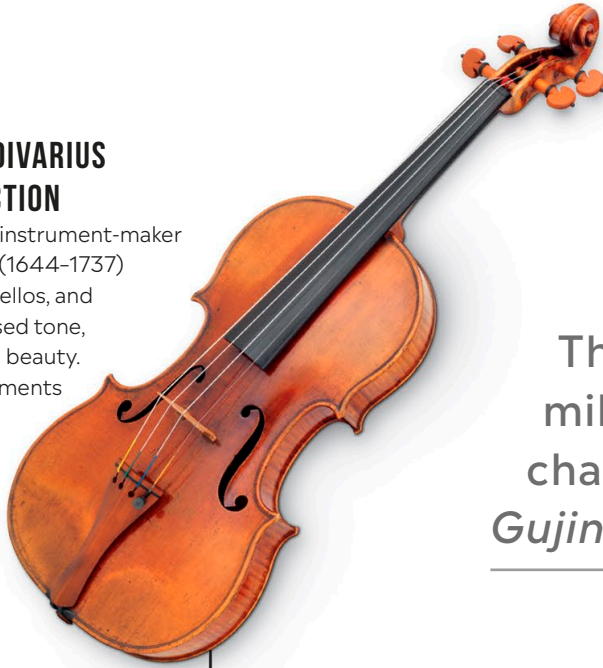


1725

PEAK OF STRADIVARIUS VIOLIN PRODUCTION

From 1700, Italian instrument-maker Antonio Stradivari (1644-1737) produced violins, cellos, and violas of unsurpassed tone, craftsmanship and beauty. Around 650 instruments have survived.

▷ Stradivarius violin



There are 100 million Chinese characters in the *Gujin Tushu Jicheng*



1725

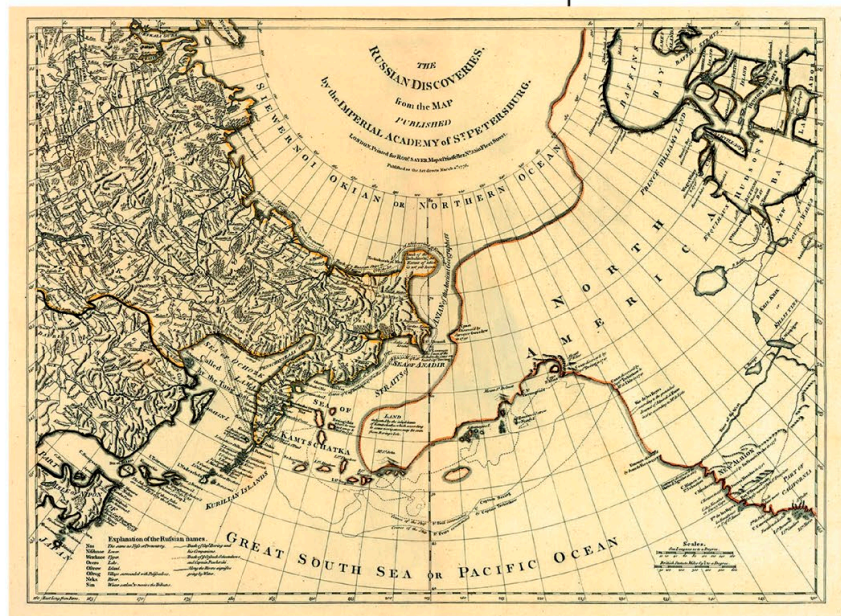
1725 Austria and Spain sign the Treaty of Vienna, shifting the balance of power in Europe

1726 *Gujin Tushu Jicheng*, China's largest pre-modern encyclopaedia is published; it fills 10,000 volumes

1728

GREAT NORTHERN EXPEDITION

The Russian Emperor Peter the Great was determined to discover the extent of his lands to the east. He commissioned Danish seaman Vitus Bering (1681-1741) to follow the Siberian coast northwards from the Kamchatka Peninsula. In 1728, Bering sailed into the strait that separates Siberia and Alaska - now named after him - and established that it was the eastern limit of Siberia. A second expedition in 1733-43 involving 3,000 people mapped Russia's vast northern coastline.



△ A map made at St Petersburg's Imperial Academy shows the limits of Russian exploration